

## Tribal walks by Shakeel Rizvi

### To discover Chhattisgarh's Bastar district

For several decades, the Bastar district in Chhattisgarh has had a controversial image, raising concerns about its safety for tourists. However, locals like Shakeel Rizvi, founder of the Bastar Tribal Homestay, are trying to bust that image through well-curated experiences focusing on the region's natural and cultural diversity. Based in Jagdalpur, which is the district HQ, Rizvi takes travellers through lesser-known villages like Gudiya, Bamnaras, Chittalgur, Bijlipara and more, and arranges interactions with locals who continue to practice a traditional way of life. Some highlights include heading out to forests to collect gum, bark, leaves, vegetables and tubers with villagers; participating in bamboo basketry, fishing and creating mats; eating local food in utensils made from sargi leaves; and witnessing cultural performances.

*https://maps.app.goo.gl/71UpTEndTN7R1APr5 (This is the contact link)*



Bamboo craft by the Dhurwa tribe; (above) a liquor market in Nangur village

The Extra Mile founder Shoba George with a pashmina goat and a Changpa child



## The Extra Mile

### For the Pashmina Trail

Pashmina, also known as 'soft gold', is coveted the world over for its luxuriant texture and warmth. Its story begins in the rarefied reaches of Ladakh's Changthang plateau where the Changpa nomads and their livestock survive in the harshest of weather conditions. The Pashmina Trail, curated by Shoba George's The Extra Mile, takes travellers through this mystical region, uncovering stories told by Ladakhis. While soaking in breathtaking views and stopping by ancient monasteries is a part of the itinerary, visits to pristine villages like Tar (which has a population of 80) are one of the highlights. There's no road to the village, one has to hike through towering mountains to get to the destination. Travellers also get an opportunity to camp with the nomads in Changthang, who take their herds out for grazing. The experience also includes culinary delights curated by food enthusiasts and celebrity chefs.

*www.theextramile.co.in*